

Project 2

Course Code and Name: MSJ2101 Communication and Technology

Project Name: Patriarchy

Project Type: Blog Writing

Semester of Submission: Fall 2022

Project Description:

This project explores how patriarchy affects men's emotions, behavior, and ideas of masculinity. It focuses on how boys are taught from a young age to hide their emotions and always appear strong. It also examines the pressure men face to be providers, protectors, and emotionally stable.

Project Justification:

This project is important because these expectations can make men feel that showing emotions is a sign of weakness. It aims to encourage men to express their feelings, ask for help, and accept vulnerability without shame. The project promotes a healthier and more open understanding of masculinity.



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Opinion Article

Course: Mass: Communication and Technology

Title: Patriarchy

Done by:

Showmiq Islam Utshow (221012042)

Patriarchy

As a man, I can confidently say from experience that patriarchy has done more harm for me than good. Living in a patriarchal society, I am expected to be strong, masculine, and tough, display no emotions whatsoever, and that can be quite toxic at times. I believe that patriarchy affects men in terms of being open-minded and emotionally expressive. From a very young age, boys are often taught that showing emotions is a sign of weakness and that they must always appear strong.

As a child, whenever I cried, I was told that it was not appropriate because I was a “Big Boy,” and “big boys” do not cry like “little girls.” I think of that statement to this day. Why I am not allowed to cry? I have feelings, I have emotions, and showing them should not devalue me as I am a human being with feelings, and it should be accepted in society.

These expectations do not disappear as boys grow older. Instead, they become more deeply rooted in everyday life. Men are often expected to be the providers, protectors, decision-makers, and emotionally stable members of the family. While responsibility is not necessarily a bad thing, the problem arises when men are made to believe that they must always handle everything alone. Asking for help, admitting fear, expressing sadness, or even simply saying that they are struggling can be viewed as weakness.

Patriarchy also creates a narrow definition of what it means to be a “real man.” Men are encouraged to be aggressive rather than vulnerable, dominant rather than understanding, and emotionally distant rather than communicative. This can affect relationships, friendships, mental well-being, and even the way men understand themselves. Sometimes, men may not even realize what they are feeling because they have spent their entire lives being told not to express it.

I believe that challenging patriarchy does not mean taking anything away from men. Instead, it gives men the freedom to be more human. Men should be able to cry, ask for help, care deeply, and show affection, and express vulnerability without being judged. Strength should not only mean being able to endure pain silently; sometimes, true strength is having the courage to acknowledge that you are hurting. Creating a society where men can express their emotions freely would not make men weaker. It would make them more emotionally aware, open-minded, and ultimately, healthier human beings.



Illustration: Nathalie Lees

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Monday, November 21, 2022

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 [Showmiq Islam Utshow \(221012042\)](#)

I am a student of ULAB. This blog is to further discover my potential abilities on online databases and story making.

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Learnings and Outcomes (Self-reflection):

- Understand how patriarchal expectations shape male emotional expression, and how these norms are instilled from a very young age.
- Learn to use personal narrative and lived experience as evidence in persuasive, opinion-based writing.
- Recognize the link between rigid gender roles and mental well-being, particularly how suppressing emotion is normalized as "strength."
- Develop a clearer, more confident first-person voice for arguing a socially sensitive position.
- Gain a stronger appreciation for how challenging patriarchal norms can benefit men rather than take anything away from them